



Your expansion into sectors like paints and jewellery, both inherently challenging, raises the question of strategic evaluation. In paints especially, you have been a serious disruptor. What opportunity matrix do you use before entering a new business? Could you illustrate this with examples from these or other recent ventures?

Our approach to new ventures is governed by a

paints was a natural adjacency, drawing on our deep experience in large-scale manufacturing and distribution from cement; while in jewellery, our expertise in fashion, retail, and consumer trends provided a clear competitive advantage.

Third, the market opportunity must be structurally attractive. We focus on industries undergoing value migration, where shifts in consumer preferences, or structural inefficiencies, create room for new leaders.

are the second-largest player by capacity, a testament to the strength of our execution.



The international business has been steadily growing through both organic and inorganic routes. How do you envision the evolution of a larger Aditya Birla multinational group, and which sectors will be the key drivers of this growth?

enterprises.

Our evolution into a truly global entity has been shaped by a series of transformative milestones—from the Novelis acquisition and the Columbian Chemicals deal to the Aleris buyout and, most recently, the Bay Minette project in Alabama, a greenfield project to set up an aluminium rolling plant. The \$4.1 billion investment in Alabama marks our largest commitment to a single project anywhere in the world, a bold move at a time when many corporations are retreating from globalisation. Our confidence in the dynamism of the American economy is underscored by the \$15 billion we have invested in the U.S. to date. Novelis alone operates 17 manufacturing facilities across the country and employs nearly 5,000 people.

Beyond metals, our chemicals business made its first foray into the U.S. last year with an R&D and manufacturing facility. Looking ahead, North America will remain a key focus, alongside India, our most critical growth market. While we continue to deepen our leadership across existing businesses, we remain attuned to emerging opportunities that align with our strengths and long-term vision. **BT**

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My approach has been to build businesses that are structurally strong, cost-efficient, and primed for long-term growth

disciplined opportunity matrix, anchored in three fundamental principles.

First, the potential for market leadership. We enter only those sectors where we see a clear and credible path to being among the top players within a reasonable time-frame. Second, we assess our inherent right to win. This means identifying sectors where we can leverage existing capabilities—whether in distribution, branding, or operational expertise. Our entry into

The jewellery sector, for instance, remains over 60% unorganised, with only a handful of national players. The largest national brand today commands a mere 6-7% market share of the total jewellery market, underscoring the vast headroom for consolidation and branded retail expansion. Likewise, in paints, we have committed ₹10,000 crore to rapidly scale up operations, commissioning five out of six manufacturing plants in under a year. Today, we

For over half a century, we have been a global conglomerate, with our expansion into Thailand under my father Mr. Aditya Vikram Birla's leadership serving as the springboard for our international ambitions.

Over the past three decades, we have steadily built a presence in more than 40 countries, establishing global leadership in multiple sectors. Today, Aditya Birla Group stands as one of India's most distinctive multinational